# Week 9 at a Glance

*Wednesday–Saturday, November 11 – 14, 2026 · about two hours each morning · AO Year 2 Term 1 week 9*

**EVERY SCHOOL DAY**

- Outdoor sit or walk, 20 min
- Bible, 10–15 min, then narrate (Fri lighter)
- Hymn or folk song, 5 min
- Ray's New Practical Arithmetic, next lesson (25–28), 15–20 min
- Copywork, one line, 10 min
- Recitation, 5 min
- One main reading + narration
- One lighter reading or riches

**HOLD ALL WEEK**

**Copywork:** "Cherries, ripe cherries!" The old woman cried,

**Recitation:** Genesis 1:1 ESV — from your physical Bible; wording not printed here. If it is solid, add verse 2. Optional: say "Chicken" by heart.

**Hymn:** "I Bind Unto Myself Today" — keep the first stanza; add the second this week if the first is solid

**Folk song:** "The Bold Grenadier" — the clearer sing-along recording on the shelf page

**Math:** Ray's Lessons 25–28. One lesson each school day. Oral first. Do not dump the book.

| DAY | BIBLE | MAIN READING | RICHES / EXTRA |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Wed 4** | Exodus 19 + Awana | Our Island Story ch. 29, King Stephen | Ray's L25 · copywork · hymn · "Bread and Cherries" |
| **Thu 5** | Exodus 20 + Awana | Little Duke, ch. 5 first half | Harvey's · Tree in the Trail ch. 7 · folk |
| **Fri 6** | hymn (lighter Bible) | Burgess Animal Book ch. 9 | Grimm · picture study · composer · pine-cone feeder · CHOW Knights |
| **Sat 7** | Luke 21:20–38 | Understood Betsy ch. 8 | Harvey's · Pilgrim's Progress · Trial and Triumph (Anselm) |

## Books to have open

- ESV Bible (physical copy; references only)
- Ray's New Practical Arithmetic (Mott) — Lessons 25–28
- Harvey's Elementary Grammar (Mott) — two short sittings
- *Our Island Story* ch. 29 · *Little Duke* ch. 5a (printed)
- *Tree in the Trail* — ch. 7 from **your copy** (catch-up; not AO ch. 13)
- Hillyer, *A Child's History of the World* — "Knights and Days of Chivalry" from **your copy**
- *Trial and Triumph* — Anselm, from **your copy**
- Grimm's Pantheon — one gentle tale by title (not printed)

## Two children

Astoria does the whole morning. Tracy joins Bible, songs, poems, animal stories, picture study, Grimm, the pine-cone feeder, and outside (see her page), with McGuffey pictures nearby during math and copywork.

## Weather

Early November: the first real cool fronts. Jackets in the morning, shirtsleeves by noon. Times slide; keep the order.

## This week's shifts

**CHOW returns** (Knights, from your copy) and **Trial and Triumph** (Anselm, from your copy). No Shakespeare: Romeo finished last week and AO schedules no tale in Weeks 9–12. No Cooper chapter

# Readings and page numbers

*Every public-domain sitting is printed in full. Edition pages let you find the same place in any copy of that edition; packet pages find it here.*

| DAY | READING | EDITION · PAGES | THIS PACKET |
|---|---|---|---|
| Wed | Our Island Story ch. 29 · The Story of King Stephen | Stokes / Constable, pp. 137–140 | **pp. 11–12** |
| Wed | "Bread and Cherries" (de la Mare) | Constable 1924, p. 15 | **p. 13** |
| Thu | The Little Duke ch. 5, first half | Macmillan, pp. 72–83 | **pp. 17–20** |
| Fri | Burgess Animal Book ch. 9 · Two Queer Little Haymakers | Little, Brown 1920, pp. 73–81 | **pp. 25–27** |
| Fri (opt.) | Burgess Animal Book ch. 10 · Prickly Porky and Grubby Gopher | Little, Brown 1920, pp. 82–89 | **pp. 28–30** |
| Sat | Understood Betsy ch. 8 | Henry Holt 1917, pp. 161–185 | **pp. 36–41** |
| Sat | The Pilgrim's Progress · Good-will, then the Interpreter's house | Dent 1910, pp. 28–31 | **pp. 42–44** |

**FROM YOUR OWN SHELF · NOT PRINTED**

- **Bible (ESV)** — Exodus 19 (Wed) · Exodus 20 (Thu) · Luke 21:20–38 (Sat). References only.
- **Tree in the Trail** (Holling) — ch. 7 (Thu).
- **A Child's History of the World** (Hillyer) — "Knights and Days of Chivalry" (ch. 51 in newer printings, ch. 49 in the 1924 first edition) (Fri).
- **Trial and Triumph** (Hannula) — the Anselm chapter (Sat).
- **Ray's New Practical Arithmetic** (Mott) — Lessons 25, 26, 27, 28, one a day.
- **Harvey's Elementary Grammar** (Mott) — next lesson, Thu and Sat.
- **Grimm's Fairy Tales** (Pantheon) — one gentle tale by title (Fri).
- **Awana workbook** — next page, Wed and Thu after Bible.
- **McGuffey Pictorial Primer** (Mott) — Tracy's picture pages, any day.

Page numbers come from the Internet Archive scans of each named edition (checked Oct 19, 2026). Other printings of the same book may run a page or two different.

# Books on the shelf (and what waits)

*What the house owns, what is assigned this week, and what waits. Copyrighted books are never reprinted.*

### YOU OWN THESE · USE FROM THE PHYSICAL COPY

**Tree in the Trail** (Holling) — catch-up this week: ch. 7 (~15–20 min, Thursday). Weeks 3–8 were ch. 1–6. Do **not** jump to AO Week 9's ch. 13. Never reprint.

**Hillyer, A Child's History of the World** — "Knights and Days of Chivalry" (ch. 51 modern / ch. 49 1st ed) on Friday, from your copy. Never reprint. Next CHOW is Week 11.

**Trial and Triumph** (Hannula) — Anselm, Saturday, from your copy. Shelf only. Never reprint. No more Trial and Triumph until Term 2.

**Seabird** (Holling) — owned. Hold until around Week 19.

### SHELF WEAVE THIS WEEK · INSIDE THE SAME MORNING

- **Ray's New Practical Arithmetic** (Mott) — Lessons 25–28; one lesson each school day; oral first.
- **Harvey's Elementary Grammar** (Mott) — two ~10 min sittings (Thu + Sat), next lesson from your place.
- **Grimm's Pantheon** — one gentle tale by title (suggested: "The Golden Goose"). Never reprint.
- **McGuffey Pictorial Primer** (Mott) — Tracy's informal picture-page while Astoria does copywork or math.
- **Awana workbook** — Wed + Thu only, 10–15 min AFTER Bible, next page in the physical book. Never reprint.

### FOLK SONG · THE CLEARER RECORDING

Keep using the plain sing-along "Bold Grenadier" that AmblesideOnline links: **youtu.be/9U631tf08sM** (folksandhymns channel). AO's folk-song page (amblesideonline.org/folksongs) lists two more recordings. Listen once, then sing a verse together.

### BUY-AHEAD · WEEKS 11–12

Nothing to buy. Weeks 11–12 use public-domain readings (printed in the packets) and books you already own (Hillyer for the Week 11 and 12 CHOW chapters, *Tree in the Trail*). Diane Stanley's *Joan of Arc* is still around Weeks 22–25, so it's too early to buy. *Seabird* is already on your shelf for about Week 19.

# How to sit with them this week

*Short lessons. One reading. Narration. Atmosphere. No teacher-book chapter to finish.*

### 01 Narration is the lesson

Read once. Close the book. Let Astoria tell it back in her own order. Do not prompt with “and then what?” A few true sentences are enough. Thank her. Do not correct the facts in the moment.

### 02 Let the great things be great

Exodus 19 and 20 are Sinai and the Ten Commandments. Read them plainly and let them be big. Don’t add a lesson after. The thunder and the trumpet will stay with her longer than an explanation would.

### 03 Two histories, two days

CHOW (Knights) and Trial and Triumph (Anselm) both come back this week, and Island Story continues. Keep them on separate days, as laid out. Then each one gets her full attention and they don’t run together.

### 04 Wait

After you close the book, wait a full ten seconds before you speak. Silence is not failure. It is the mind at work.

### 05 Masterly inactivity

In the afternoons, step back. With the cooler weather, leave them outside to dig, climb, and build. That free time belongs to the school day too.

### 06 Two children

Tracy joins the stories, songs, poems, Burgess, Grimm, picture study, the pine-cone feeder, and nature. She is not expected to narrate. Quiet play or McGuffey pictures during math and copywork.

### 07 Keep the shelf books light

Ray’s, Harvey’s, Awana, Grimm, TITT, CHOW, and Trial and Triumph all fit into the same mornings. There is no extra school day for them. Awana only Wed and Thu, after Bible.

### 08 Smaller steps, still forward

Recitation has been Genesis 1:1 for a long time. If she says it without a stumble, add verse 2 this week. If not, keep verse 1. Either way, five minutes a day is enough.

# How to teach this week

*Island Story ch. 29. Little Duke opens ch. 5. Exodus 19–20 and Luke 21. CHOW Knights and Anselm from your shelf.*

### 01 Bible without a sermon

Wednesday: Exodus 19 (the people camp at Mount Sinai; thunder, smoke, and a trumpet as God comes down on the mountain). Thursday: Exodus 20 (the Ten Commandments). Saturday: Luke 21:20–38 (Jesus speaks of Jerusalem, signs in the sky, the fig tree, and staying awake). Friday: lighter, hymn first. Open your ESV; never print verse text.

### 02 Awana, Wed and Thu only

Ten to fifteen minutes AFTER Bible. Next page in their physical Awana book. Never reprint Awana. No Awana Fri or Sat.

### 03 Ray's Lessons 25–28

Continue after Week 8's Lessons 21–24. One lesson each school day. Oral first when the book allows. Do not dump pages. Tracy plays nearby with McGuffey pictures.

### 04 Copywork and recitation

New line from de la Mare's "Bread and Cherries": *"Cherries, ripe cherries!" The old woman cried,* Best handwriting, then stop. Recitation: Genesis 1:1 from your ESV (reference only here); add 1:2 if verse 1 is solid. Optional: "Chicken" by heart.

### 05 Island Story ch. 29 · King Stephen

Printed in full (about 1,100 words, short). The barons choose gentle Stephen instead of Henry's daughter Matilda. Then the Battle of the Standard, the civil war, and Matilda's escape from Oxford over the ice in white cloaks. It ends with the Peace of Wallingford. **Intensity note:** it mentions the barons' cruel dungeons in a sentence or two. Nothing is described in detail.

### 06 CHOW · Knights (Friday)

Hillyer, "Knights and Days of Chivalry," from **your copy** (ch. 51 modern / ch. 49 first edition). Page, squire, knight; armor and coats of arms. One sitting, narrate. Never reprint. It follows Week 7's "Real Castles" well.

### 07 Little Duke, ch. 5 first half

Night at Rouen. Osmond and Sir Eric learn the King means to carry Richard off. Alberic climbs down the buttress to warn Bernard. In the morning Richard loses his temper at the guarded door and gives himself away, and the Normans hide him in Fru Astrida's turret. Printed (about 2,150 words). If attention fades, stop at "So you have failed, Osmond?" and finish Friday.

### 08 Tree in the Trail, ch. 7

From **your copy**. One sitting Thursday, ~15–20 min. Still catching up (Weeks 3–8 were ch. 1–6). Do **not** jump to AO's ch. 13. Never reprint TITT.

### 09 Harvey's, twice

Two ~10-minute sittings (Thu and Sat), the next lesson from where you stopped. Oral and light.

### 10 Grimm by title only

Open your Pantheon. One gentle tale — suggested: "The Golden Goose" (Simpleton shares his food, and everyone who touches the goose sticks fast). If you've read it, use "Mother Holle" or "The Fisherman and His Wife." Never reprint.

### 11 Burgess, one chapter (two if it goes well)

Ch. 9, "Two Queer Little Haymakers" (Little Chief the pika and Stubtail the mountain beaver), is the week's chapter. Week 8 printed it as optional. If you already read it, review briefly and go on to ch. 10, "Prickly Porky and Grubby Gopher" (the porcupine and the pocket gopher), printed as optional. Do not jump to AO's ch. 12.

### 12 What you are not doing

No Shakespeare (AO has none in Weeks 9–12). No Cooper chapter. No Seabird until ~Week 19. No Parables from Nature. No jumping ahead in Tree in the Trail. No Wind in the Willows (finished).

# How to teach this week

*Betsy, Pilgrim's Progress, Anselm, early-November riches, and a handicraft.*

### 13 Understood Betsy, ch. 8

"Betsy Starts a Sewing Society." Long (about 4,300 words), so read it in two sittings: Saturday up to the break marked in the text, the rest Saturday afternoon or early next week. Betsy hears about 'Lias Brewster, the ragged little boy nobody looks after. She and the other girls start a sewing society to make him clothes, with Cousin Ann teaching on Saturday afternoons. Ask what Betsy decided to do, and why.

### 14 Pilgrim's Progress · inside the gate

Picks up right after "I rejoice and tremble." Good-will asks Christian how he came, shows him the straight and narrow way, and sends him to the house of the Interpreter. The Interpreter shows him the first picture, of a grave man with the best of books in his hand. About 1,300 words; you may stop at "he again bid him God-speed" and read the Interpreter part another day.

### 15 Trial and Triumph · Anselm (Saturday)

From **your copy** only; never reprint. Anselm was a monk who became Archbishop of Canterbury under William the Red and Henry I, the kings from Weeks 7 and 8. One sitting, ~15–20 min. Ask her what Anselm would not do, even for a king.

### 16 Poetry: "Bread and Cherries"

Walter de la Mare, *Peacock Pie*. Eight lines: an old woman in a white apron calls "Cherries, ripe cherries!" and the boys come running to buy some for their bread. Both children. Copywork comes from the first two lines.

### 17 Dictation (optional, Saturday)

Have her study *cherries* and *cried* until she can see them with her eyes shut, then write *"Cherries, ripe cherries!" The old woman cried,* as you say it once. Five minutes. Skip it if she's tired.

### 18 Term 1 riches

Hymn: "I Bind Unto Myself Today" — first stanza, and the second if the first is solid. Folk: "The Bold Grenadier," the clearer recording from the shelf page. Picture study: Rockwell, *Freedom from Fear*, the last of the Four Freedoms. Look for two minutes, turn it over, have her describe it. Composer: Bernstein, *Three Dance Episodes from On the Town* (the next work on AO's Bernstein list after *Jeremiah*), 5–8 minutes while drawing or dancing. Nothing copyrighted is printed.

### 19 Nature · Lost Pines, early November

The first cool fronts blow through. Listen for sandhill cranes passing high overhead (a rolling, rattling call), and look for ruby-crowned kinglets and yellow-rumped warblers in the pines. Red possumhaw and yaupon berries, purple beautyberry, post-oak acorns, flameleaf sumac turning red, loblolly needles dropping. Woolly bear caterpillars and orb-weaver webs. After a rain, visit a creek. One drawing, date it, scribe one sentence. Watch for fire ants.

### 20 Handicraft · pine-cone bird feeder

Wednesday walk: collect two or three open loblolly cones. Friday: tie a string to the top, spread with sunflower butter or shortening, and roll in birdseed. Hang it where you can watch from a window. Twenty minutes, then stop. Tracy rolls the cone in seed.

### 21 Preschool corner

Tracy's informal page is in this packet. Same as Week 8: stories and songs, a cherry-seller game after the poem, McGuffey pictures nearby, no worksheets.

### 22 Intensity / preview

Gentler than Week 8. Sinai is loud and solemn. Little Duke is exciting, since Richard is in danger but safe by the end of the sitting. King Stephen has a civil war and a snowy escape. Week 10 brings Exodus 31:18–33, Luke 22:1–13, Island Story ch. 30 (Gilbert and Rohesia), and the second half of Little Duke ch. 5.

# Tracy’s week

*She joins what fits. She is not expected to narrate, copy, or sit through math.*

### 01 Join freely

Nature sits and walks, Bible (as long as she’ll sit), the hymn and “The Bold Grenadier,” “Bread and Cherries,” the Burgess pika and mountain-beaver chapter, the Grimm tale, picture study, the On the Town dances, and the pine-cone feeder.

### 02 Nearby during hard work

McGuffey Pictorial Primer picture-pages, a busy-hands basket, or quiet play while Astoria does Ray’s, copywork, Island Story, Little Duke, CHOW, Anselm, or Harvey’s.

### 03 Cherry-seller game

After the poem, Tracy carries a basket of red balls or pom-poms and calls “Cherries!” Everyone buys one with a pretend penny. Do it once or twice, then stop. No worksheet.

### 04 Awana days

She may listen near Bible and Awana on Wed and Thu, or play in the same room. She does not do the workbook.

### 05 Outside is her classroom

Early-November Lost Pines: pine cones, red berries on the yaupon (look, don’t eat), acorns to collect, a woolly bear to watch (don’t squeeze). Name one thing each day.

### 06 Pine-cone feeder

She helps find cones Wednesday. Friday she rolls the sticky cone in seed. Then watch together for the first bird to come.

### 07 Haymakers

After Burgess, she can “make hay” like Little Chief the pika: gather a pile of grass or leaves and tuck it under a bush for winter. Then stop.

### 08 What Tracy is not doing

No worksheets, no recitation, no scoring. If she’s fussy, the morning keeps its order and nothing more is added.

# Wednesday

**HAVE READY**

Bible · Awana workbook · hymn words · Ray's (Lesson 25) · copywork line · *Our Island Story* ch. 29 (printed) · "Bread and Cherries" · a bag for pine cones · nature notebook · McGuffey nearby

**8:00** — **Nature walk + pine-cone hunt** TRACY JOINS

Twenty minutes. Collect two or three open pine cones for Friday's feeder. Listen for cranes overhead; look for one red berry.

**8:25** — **Bible · Exodus 19**

Open your ESV to Exodus 19. Israel camps at Mount Sinai; the mountain smokes and a trumpet sounds. Read once, close the Bible, narrate, then stop.

**8:40** — **Awana** AFTER BIBLE

Ten to fifteen minutes. Next page in the physical Awana book. Never reprint.

**8:55** — **Hymn** TRACY JOINS

"I Bind Unto Myself Today." First stanza; try the second if the first is solid. Sing it; don't explain it.

**9:05** — **Ray's · Lesson 25**

Next lesson after Week 8's Lesson 24. Oral first. One lesson. Tracy: McGuffey picture-page or busy-hands basket.

**9:25** — **Copywork + recitation**

Copywork: *"Cherries, ripe cherries!" The old woman cried,* Recitation: Genesis 1:1 from your ESV (wording not printed); add 1:2 if ready.

**9:40** — **History · Island Story ch. 29**

"The Story of King Stephen." Printed. Short (~10 min). Narrate. **Stop.**

**10:00** — **Poem · "Bread and Cherries"** TRACY JOINS

Read once. Both children. Then Tracy's cherry-seller game, once.

# How to teach Wednesday

> **Island Story ch. 29.** Printed in full and short. Sinai begins. CHOW and Trial and Triumph come later in the week, on their own days.

## Bible and Awana

Exodus 19: in the third month out of Egypt, Israel camps before the mountain. The people wash and wait three days; then come thunder, lightning, a thick cloud, a very loud trumpet, and the mountain wrapped in smoke. One reading; let her narrate the scene. Awana after Bible, physical book only.

## Ray’s Lesson 25

Pick up the Mott Ray’s where Week 8 stopped. Oral first. Stop after one lesson even if she’s eager.

## Island Story

Henry I’s daughter Matilda should have been queen, but the barons choose his gentle nephew Stephen, hoping to do as they like. The Battle of the Standard, the civil war, and the best part: Matilda and three knights in white cloaks slipping out of besieged Oxford and across the frozen Thames. It ends with the Peace of Wallingford and young Henry Plantagenet. Ask her why the knights wore white.

## Poem

“Bread and Cherries” is this week’s poem and copywork. Eight short lines. Read it for delight; no lesson.

Tracy: pine-cone hunt, Bible as long as she’ll sit, hymn, poem and cherry game. McGuffey or the busy-hands basket during Ray’s and copywork. She may stay for Island Story if she is quiet.

READ THIS · WEDNESDAY

# Bible · Exodus 19

*ESV · open your physical copy · never reprint verse text*

### Open your ESV to Exodus 19.

Read once. Close the Bible. Narrate. Then stop.

Do not print or paste ESV (or any modern) Bible text — use the physical book only.
Israel at Mount Sinai: thunder, smoke, and the trumpet. One chapter.

READ THIS · WEDNESDAY

# Our Island Story · Chapter 29 · The Story of King Stephen

*H. E. Marshall, An Island Story: A Child's History of England (New York: Frederick A. Stokes; printed in Edinburgh by T. and A. Constable), ch. XXIX, **pp. 137–140**. Same text as Our Island Story (London: T. C. & E. C. Jack, 1905). Public domain. Full chapter. · This packet: pp. 11–12*

Henry I. died in 1135 A.D., and the barons, instead of keeping their promise to him and making his daughter queen, chose his nephew Stephen to be their king. Stephen was the son of Adela, William the Conqueror's daughter.

The barons chose Stephen for several reasons. They were so proud that they hated the thought of being ruled by a woman, and that woman, too, not even a Norman. For you remember Matilda's mother was a great-granddaughter of Edmund Ironside, and as she had been born in England and lived a great part of her life there she was far more English than Norman.

Matilda's husband was Geoffrey, Count of Anjou. He was also called Geoffrey Plantagenet, because when he went into battle he used to wear a sprig of yellow broom in his helmet, so that his friends might know him when his face was covered with his visor. The Latin name for broom is planta genista, and gradually it came to be pronounced Plantagenet.

Although Geoffrey was French he was not a Norman, and the Normans looked upon him as quite as much a stranger as an Englishman, and they did not wish to be ruled by him, as would happen if his wife Matilda were made queen. Besides this, the barons knew that Stephen was kind and gentle, and they thought he would be a king who would allow them to do just what they liked.

And so he did. Stephen was too gentle to rule the wild barons. Some one stern and harsh was needed to keep them in check, and Stephen was neither. He allowed the barons to build strong castles all over the country. These castles had dark and fearful dungeons, which were used as prisons. There such deeds of cruelty were done by the barons that the people said the castles were filled, not with men, but with evil spirits. 'God has forgotten England,' they said. 'Christ sleeps and His holy ones.'

Not even at the time of the Conquest had there been such misery in England. Then there had been one stern ruler who had forced every one to bend to his will. Now each baron set himself up as a king and tyrant. His castle was his kingdom, where he tortured and killed according to his own wicked will. Stephen was a courteous knight and gentleman, but during the nineteen years of his reign there was only lawlessness and sorrow in England.

When the barons made Stephen King of England, Matilda and her husband Geoffrey fled to Normandy. But there, too, the barons rebelled against them and chose Stephen for their duke.

Then David, the King of Scotland, gathered an army and came to fight for his niece Matilda.

Ever since the days of the Romans the Scotch and English had been enemies, and the Scotch were still almost as wild and fierce as they had been then. They marched through England as far as Yorkshire, doing dreadful deeds of cruelty as they went.

At a place called Northallerton a great battle was fought. It was called the Battle of the Standard because the sacred banners of four saints were hung upon a pole, which was fixed to a cart, and round this the English gathered their forces.

The Scots were fiercely brave, but they wore no armour, and, although they rushed to battle with splendid courage, they could not break through the line of steel-clad Normans, nor stand against the arrows of the English. So they were defeated, and David could not help Matilda as he had meant to do.

Later on Matilda came back from France, and, until the death of Stephen, England was filled with civil war. Civil war means war within a country itself—the people of that country, instead of fighting against a foreign nation, fighting among themselves. This is the most terrible kind of war, for often friends and brothers fight on different sides, killing and wounding each other. In this civil war those who wished Matilda to be queen fought against those who wished Stephen to remain king.

For a time Matilda's army was successful, but she was so proud and haughty that she soon made enemies even of those who had at first fought for her. Then came a time when she was shut up in Oxford, while the army of Stephen lay around. The King's soldiers kept so strict a watch that no food could be taken into the town, and no person could escape from it. This is called a siege. The people in Oxford began to starve, for they had eaten up all the food they had, and Stephen's soldiers took good care that no more was allowed to be taken into the town. It was the middle of winter. The river Thames was frozen over. Snow lay everywhere around. The cold was terrible, and the people had no wood for fires.

At last Matilda could bear it no longer. She made up her mind to run away. One night four figures dressed in white crept silently through the streets of Oxford. They reached the gate. In silence it was opened, for those guarding it knew who the white-clad figures were. One by one the figures passed through. Out into the snow-covered fields they crept, moving softly and swiftly, unnoticed by Stephen's soldiers. It was Matilda and three faithful knights. They had dressed themselves in white so that they might pass unseen over the snow. There was no bridge over the river, but the frost was so hard that they crossed upon the ice and so got safely away.

Although Matilda fled, the war still went on until at length her son Henry landed in England, determined to fight for the crown. But Stephen was weary of war, and all the land longed for rest. So listening to the advice of a wise priest, Stephen and Henry made peace.

Their first meeting was on the banks of the Thames where it runs still as a little stream. They stood one on one bank, and one on the other—Stephen a broken, ruined man, worn and aged with wars and troubles, Henry young, handsome, and hopeful. And there they made a treaty called the Peace of Wallingford. By this treaty it was agreed, that Stephen should keep the crown while he lived; that he should acknowledge Henry as his adopted son; that Henry should reign after the death of Stephen; and that the dreadful castles which Stephen had allowed the wicked barons to build, and which they used as dark and horrible prisons, should be destroyed.

So the land had rest. Soon afterward Stephen died, and in 1154 A.D. Henry came to the throne amid the great rejoicing of the people.

> **End of chapter.** Narrate. Next week: ch. 30, Henry Plantagenet — The Story of Gilbert and Rohesia.

READ THIS · WEDNESDAY

# Bread and Cherries

*Walter de la Mare, Peacock Pie: A Book of Rhymes (London: Constable; 1924 printing),* ***p. 15****. Text: Project Gutenberg #3753 (1913). Public domain. This week's copywork comes from here. · This packet: p. 13*

*'Cherries, ripe cherries!'*
*The old woman cried,*
*In her snowy white apron,*
*And basket beside;*
*And the little boys came,*
*Eyes shining, cheeks red,*
*To buy a bag of cherries,*
*To eat with their bread.*

> **Copywork:** "Cherries, ripe cherries!" The old woman cried,

# Thursday

**HAVE READY**

Bible · Awana workbook · Ray's (Lesson 26) · *The Little Duke* ch. 5 first half (printed) · *Tree in the Trail* (your copy, ch. 7) · Harvey's · folk song recording · McGuffey nearby

**8:00** — **Nature sit** TRACY JOINS

Porch or backyard, twenty minutes. Feel the morning after a cool front. Listen for kinglets and warblers in the pines.

**8:25** — **Bible · Exodus 20**

The Ten Commandments. Read once, narrate, stop. No lecture after.

**8:40** — **Awana** AFTER BIBLE

Ten to fifteen minutes. Next page. Then put it away.

**8:55** — **Folk song** TRACY JOINS

"The Bold Grenadier," with the clearer sing-along recording (shelf page). One verse.

**9:05** — **Ray's · Lesson 26**

One lesson. Oral first. Tracy nearby with McGuffey.

**9:25** — **Tales · Little Duke ch. 5a**

Printed. The King's plot, Alberic's climb, Richard's temper at the door, the turret. Cap ~20 min; you may stop at "So you have failed, Osmond?" Narrate.

**9:50** — **Geography · Tree in the Trail ch. 7**

From your copy, ~15–20 min. Narrate. Do not jump ahead to AO's ch. 13.

**10:15** — **Harvey's · short sitting**

About ten minutes, next lesson, oral and light. Then stop.

# How to teach Thursday

> **Little Duke opens ch. 5.** Tree in the Trail from your copy. Harvey's first sitting. Copywork can go here if Wednesday was full.

## Bible and Awana

Exodus 20 is the Ten Commandments, then the people standing far off, afraid of the thunder. Read it straight through once. She may want to count them on her fingers; let her. Awana after.

## Little Duke

Last week Richard liked King Louis. Now, at night, Osmond and Sir Eric find the King means to carry him off. Alberic climbs down the buttress to warn Bernard and the people of Rouen. In the morning Osmond tries to slip Richard out as a page, but Richard shouts that he is the Duke and gives himself away. They hide him in the turret with Fru Astrida, and he is sorry for his temper. Ask what went wrong at the door.

## Tree in the Trail

Chapter 7, from your physical book. One sitting. Find the place on the trail map if your copy has one. Never reprint.

## Harvey's

First of two short sittings. Oral. Next lesson from your place.

Tracy: nature, Bible, folk song. McGuffey during Ray's and Harvey's. She may listen to Little Duke if she is content.

READ THIS · THURSDAY

# Bible · Exodus 20

*ESV · open your physical copy · never reprint verse text*

### Open your ESV to Exodus 20.

Read once. Close the Bible. Narrate. Then stop.

Do not print or paste ESV (or any modern) Bible text — use the physical book only.
The Ten Commandments. One chapter — Awana follows.

# The Little Duke · Chapter 5 · first half

*Charlotte M. Yonge, The Little Duke (London & New York: Macmillan), ch. V, first half, **pp. 72–83** (Macmillan printing scanned at the Internet Archive). Text: Project Gutenberg #3048, from the 1905 Macmillan edition. Public domain. · This packet: pp. 17–20*

Duke Richard of Normandy slept in the room which had been his father's; Alberic de Montemar, as his page, slept at his feet, and Osmond de Centeville had a bed on the floor, across the door, where he lay with his sword close at hand, as his young Lord's guard and protector.

All had been asleep for some little time, when Osmond was startled by a slight movement of the door, which could not be pushed open without awakening him. In an instant he had grasped his sword, while he pressed his shoulder to the door to keep it closed; but it was his father's voice that answered him with a few whispered words in the Norse tongue, "It is I, open." He made way instantly, and old Sir Eric entered, treading cautiously with bare feet, and sat down on the bed motioning him to do the same, so that they might be able to speak lower. "Right, Osmond," he said. "It is well to be on the alert, for peril enough is around him—The Frank means mischief! I know from a sure hand that Arnulf of Flanders was in council with him just before he came hither, with his false tongue, wiling and coaxing the poor child!"

"Ungrateful traitor!" murmured Osmond. "Do you guess his purpose?"

"Yes, surely, to carry the boy off with him, and so he trusts doubtless to cut off all the race of Rollo! I know his purpose is to bear off the Duke, as a ward of the Crown forsooth. Did you not hear him luring the child with his promises of friendship with the Princes? I could not understand all his French words, but I saw it plain enough."

"You will never allow it?"

"If he does, it must be across our dead bodies; but taken as we are by surprise, our resistance will little avail. The Castle is full of French, the hall and court swarm with them. Even if we could draw our Normans together, we should not be more than a dozen men, and what could we do but die? That we are ready for, if it may not be otherwise, rather than let our charge be thus borne off without a pledge for his safety, and without the knowledge of the states."

"The king could not have come at a worse time," said Osmond.

"No, just when Bernard the Dane is absent. If he only knew what has befallen, he could raise the country, and come to the rescue."

"Could we not send some one to bear the tidings to-night?"

"I know not," said Sir Eric, musingly. "The French have taken the keeping of the doors; indeed they are so thick through the Castle that I can hardly reach one of our men, nor could I spare one hand that may avail to guard the boy to-morrow."

"Sir Eric;" a bare little foot was heard on the floor, and Alberic de Montemar stood before him. "I did not mean to listen, but I could not help hearing you. I cannot fight for the Duke yet, but I could carry a message."

"How would that be?" said Osmond, eagerly. "Once out of the Castle, and in Rouen, he could easily find means of sending to the Count. He might go either to the Convent of St. Ouen, or, which would be better, to the trusty armourer, Thibault, who would soon find man and horse to send after the Count."

"Ha! let me see," said Sir Eric. "It might be. But how is he to get out?"

"I know a way," said Alberic. "I scrambled down that wide buttress by the east wall last week, when our ball was caught in a branch of the ivy, and the drawbridge is down."

“If Bernard knew, it would be off my mind, at least!” said Sir Eric. “Well, my young Frenchman, you may do good service.”

“Osmond,” whispered Alberic, as he began hastily to dress himself, “only ask one thing of Sir Eric—never to call me young Frenchman again!”

Sir Eric smiled, saying, “Prove yourself Norman, my boy.”

“Then,” added Osmond, “if it were possible to get the Duke himself out of the castle to-morrow morning. If I could take him forth by the postern, and once bring him into the town, he would be safe. It would be only to raise the burghers, or else to take refuge in the Church of Our Lady till the Count came up, and then Louis would find his prey out of his hands when he awoke and sought him.”

“That might be,” replied Sir Eric; “but I doubt your success. The French are too eager to hold him fast, to let him slip out of their hands. You will find every door guarded.”

“Yes, but all the French have not seen the Duke, and the sight of a squire and a little page going forth, will scarcely excite their suspicion.”

“Ay, if the Duke would bear himself like a little page; but that you need not hope for. Besides, he is so taken with this King’s flatteries, that I doubt whether he would consent to leave him for the sake of Count Bernard. Poor child, he is like to be soon taught to know his true friends.”

“I am ready,” said Alberic, coming forward.

The Baron de Centeville repeated his instructions, and then undertook to guard the door, while his son saw Alberic set off on his expedition. Osmond went with him softly down the stairs, then avoiding the hall, which was filled with French, they crept silently to a narrow window, guarded by iron bars, placed at such short intervals apart that only so small and slim a form as Alberic’s could have squeezed out between them. The distance to the ground was not much more than twice his own height, and the wall was so covered with ivy, that it was not a very dangerous feat for an active boy, so that Alberic was soon safe on the ground, then looking up to wave his cap, he ran on along the side of the moat, and was soon lost to Osmond’s sight in the darkness.

Osmond returned to the Duke’s chamber, and relieved his father’s guard, while Richard slept soundly on, little guessing at the plots of his enemies, or at the schemes of his faithful subjects for his protection.

Osmond thought this all the better, for he had small trust in Richard’s patience and self-command, and thought there was much more chance of getting him unnoticed out of the Castle, if he did not know how much depended on it, and how dangerous his situation was.

When Richard awoke, he was much surprised at missing Alberic, but Osmond said he was gone into the town to Thibault the armourer, and this was a message on which he was so likely to be employed that Richard’s suspicion was not excited. All the time he was dressing he talked about the King, and everything he meant to show him that day; then, when he was ready, the first thing was as usual to go to attend morning mass.

“Not by that way, to-day, my Lord,” said Osmond, as Richard was about to enter the great hall. “It is crowded with the French who have been sleeping there all night; come to the postern.”

Osmond turned, as he spoke, along the passage, walking fast, and not sorry that Richard was lingering a little, as it was safer for him to be first. The postern was, as he expected, guarded by two tall steel-cased figures, who immediately held their lances across the door-way, saying, “None passes without warrant.”

“You will surely let us of the Castle attend to our daily business,” said Osmond. “You will hardly break your fast this morning if you stop all communication with the town.”

“You must bring warrant,” repeated one of the men-at-arms. Osmond was beginning to say that he was the son of the Seneschal of the Castle, when Richard came hastily up. “What? Do these men want to stop us?” he exclaimed in the imperious manner he had begun to take up since his accession. “Let us go on, sirs.”

The men-at-arms looked at each other, and guarded the door more closely. Osmond saw it was hopeless, and only wanted to draw his young charge back without being recognised, but Richard exclaimed loudly, “What means this?”

“The King has given orders that none should pass without warrant,” was Osmond’s answer. “We must wait.”

“I will pass!” said Richard, impatient at opposition, to which he was little accustomed. “What mean you, Osmond? This is my Castle, and no one has a right to stop me. Do you hear, grooms? let me go. I am the Duke!”

The sentinels bowed, but all they said was, “Our orders are express.”

“I tell you I am Duke of Normandy, and I will go where I please in my own city!” exclaimed Richard, passionately pressing against the crossed staves of the weapons, to force his way between them, but he was caught and held fast in the powerful gauntlet of one of the men-at-arms. “Let me go, villain!” cried he, struggling with all his might. “Osmond, Osmond, help!”

Even as he spoke Osmond had disengaged him from the grasp of the Frenchman, and putting his hand on his arm, said, “Nay, my Lord, it is not for you to strive with such as these.”

“I will strive!” cried the boy. “I will not have my way barred in my own Castle. I will tell the King how these rogues of his use me. I will have them in the dungeon. Sir Eric! where is Sir Eric?”

Away he rushed to the stairs, Osmond hurrying after him, lest he should throw himself into some fresh danger, or by his loud calls attract the French, who might then easily make him prisoner. However, on the very first step of the stairs stood Sir Eric, who was too anxious for the success of the attempt to escape, to be very far off. Richard, too angry to heed where he was going, dashed up against him without seeing him, and as the old Baron took hold of him, began, “Sir Eric, Sir Eric, those French are villains! they will not let me pass—“

“Hush, hush! my Lord,” said Sir Eric. “Silence! come here.”

However imperious with others, Richard from force of habit always obeyed Sir Eric, and now allowed himself to be dragged hastily and silently by him, Osmond following closely, up the stairs, up a second and a third winding flight, still narrower, and with broken steps, to a small round, thick-walled turret chamber, with an extremely small door, and loop-holes of windows high up in the tower. Here, to his great surprise, he found Dame Astrida, kneeling and telling her beads, two or three of her maidens, and about four of the Norman Squires and men-at-arms.

“So you have failed, Osmond?” said the Baron.

“But what is all this? How did Fru Astrida come up here? May I not go to the King and have those insolent Franks punished?”

“Listen to me, Lord Richard,” said Sir Eric: “that smooth-spoken King whose words so charmed you last night is an ungrateful deceiver. The Franks have always hated and feared the Normans, and not being able to conquer us fairly, they now take to foul means. Louis came hither from Flanders, he has brought this great troop of French to surprise us, claim you as a ward of the crown, and carry you away with him to some prison of his own.”

“You will not let me go?” said Richard.

“Not while I live,” said Sir Eric. “Alberic is gone to warn the Count of Harcourt, to call the Normans together, and here we are ready to defend this chamber to our last breath, but we are few, the French are many, and succour may be far off.”

“Then you meant to have taken me out of their reach this morning, Osmond?”

“Yes, my Lord.”

“And if I had not flown into a passion and told who I was, I might have been safe! O Sir Eric! Sir Eric! you will not let me be carried off to a French prison!”

“Here, my child,” said Dame Astrida, holding out her arms, “Sir Eric will do all he can for you, but we are in God’s hands!”

Richard came and leant against her. “I wish I had not been in a passion!” said he, sadly, after a silence; then looking at her in wonder—“But how came you up all this way?”

“It is a long way for my old limbs,” said Fru Astrida, smiling, “but my son helped me, and he deems it the only safe place in the Castle.”

“The safest,” said Sir Eric, “and that is not saying much for it.”

> **Stop here.** Next week: chapter 5, second half — the Normans on the stair and the King’s oath.

OPEN YOUR COPY · THURSDAY

# Tree in the Trail · Chapter 7

*Holling C. Holling — owned copy · never reprinted in this packet*

### Open your Tree in the Trail to chapter 7.

One sitting, ~15–20 min. Read once, narrate, stop.

Catch-up: Weeks 3–8 were ch. 1–6. Do not jump to AO Week 9's ch. 13.

Never reprint Holling.

READ THIS · THURSDAY · FROM YOUR SHELF

# Harvey’s Elementary Grammar · short sitting

*Mott Media reprint · owned copy · never reprinted*

### Open Harvey’s to your place.

About ten minutes. Oral and light. First sitting of the week. Stop.

Do not dump the book.

# Friday

**HAVE READY**

Hymn words · Ray's (Lesson 27) · *Burgess* ch. 9 (printed; ch. 10 optional) · Grimm's Pantheon · Rockwell *Freedom from Fear* (book or screen) · Bernstein *On the Town* dances · pine cones, string, sunflower butter or shortening, birdseed · Hillyer CHOW (your copy) · McGuffey nearby

**8:00** — **Nature sit** TRACY JOINS

Twenty minutes. Acorns, red berries, a woolly bear.

**8:25** — **Hymn · lighter Bible day**

Sing the first stanza (and the second if you've added it). No new passage today.

**8:35** — **Ray's · Lesson 27**

One lesson. Oral first.

**8:55** — **Nature lore · Burgess ch. 9** TRACY JOINS

Little Chief the Pika and Stubtail the Mountain Beaver. Printed. Narrate. Ch. 10 (the porcupine and the gopher) only if she asks for more, or if ch. 9 was read last week.

**9:20** — **Grimm · by title** TRACY JOINS

From your Pantheon — "The Golden Goose" suggested. One tale. Narrate.

**9:35** — **Picture study + composer** TRACY JOINS

Rockwell *Freedom from Fear*: look, turn it over, describe it. Then Bernstein's *On the Town* dances while she draws.

**9:55** — **Handicraft · pine-cone feeder** TRACY JOINS

String, spread, roll in seed, hang it. Twenty minutes, then stop.

**10:20** — **CHOW · Knights and Days of Chivalry**

From your Hillyer. One sitting, ~15 min. Narrate. Never reprint.

# How to teach Friday

> **No Awana. Lighter Bible.** Protect the Burgess narration. Handicraft before CHOW. CHOW is from your own copy — not printed here.

## Burgess

Ch. 9 is the week's chapter: Little Chief the Pika, who cuts and dries hay for winter among the mountain rocks, and Stubtail the Mountain Beaver, who isn't a beaver at all. If you already read it as Week 8's optional sitting, review it in one minute and go on to ch. 10, "Prickly Porky and Grubby Gopher."

## Grimm

"The Golden Goose" (or "Mother Holle" / "The Fisherman and His Wife" if it's familiar). One tale. Close the book. Let her tell it.

## Picture study and composer

*Freedom from Fear* shows a mother and father tucking two children into bed at night while the father holds a newspaper. Ask what the children don't have to be afraid of. Bernstein's *On the Town* is a lively musical about three sailors on one day in New York. Just listen, or let her dance.

## Handicraft

Pine-cone bird feeder. Open cones hold the most seed. Use sunflower butter or shortening if anyone has a peanut allergy. Hang it near a window and keep watch over the weekend.

## CHOW · Knights

Hillyer, "Knights and Days of Chivalry," from your copy. Page at seven, squire at fourteen, knighted at twenty-one; armor, tournaments, and coats of arms. After narration she may design a coat of arms for the family. Never reprint.

Tracy: nature, hymn, Burgess, Grimm, picture study, music, pine-cone feeder. McGuffey during Ray's and CHOW.

READ THIS · FRIDAY

# The Burgess Animal Book · Chapter 9 · Two Queer Little Haymakers

*Thornton W. Burgess, The Burgess Animal Book for Children (Boston: Little, Brown, 1920), ch. IX, **pp. 73–81**. Text: Project Gutenberg #2441. Public domain. Full chapter (printed as optional in Week 8). · This packet: pp. 25–27*

There is nothing like a little knowledge to make one want more. Johnny Chuck, who had gone to school only because Old Mother Nature had sent for him, had become as full of curiosity as Peter Rabbit. The discovery that he had a big, handsome cousin, Whistler the Marmot, living in the mountains of the Far West, had given Johnny something to think about. It seemed to Johnny such a queer place for a member of his family to live that he wanted to know more about it. So Johnny had a question all ready when Old Mother Nature called school to order the next morning.

“If you please, Mother Nature,” said he, “does my cousin, Whistler, have any neighbors up among those rocks where he lives?”

“He certainly does,” replied Old Mother Nature, nodding her head. “He has for a near neighbor one of the quaintest and most interesting little members of the big order to which you all belong. And that order is what?” she asked abruptly.

“The order of Rodents,” replied Peter Rabbit promptly.

“Right, Peter,” replied Old Mother Nature, smiling at Peter. “I asked that just to see if you really are learning. I wanted to make sure that I am not wasting my time with you little folks. Now this little neighbor of Whistler is Little Chief Hare.”

Instantly Peter Rabbit and Jumper the Hare pricked up their long ears and became more interested than ever, if that were possible. “I thought you had told us all about our family,” cried Jumper, “but you didn’t mention Little Chief.”

“No,” said Old Mother Nature, “I didn’t, and the reason I didn’t was because Little Chief isn’t a member of your family. He is called Little Chief Hare, but he isn’t a Hare at all, although he looks much like a small Rabbit with short hind legs and rounded ears. He has a family all to himself and should be called a Pika. Some folks do call him that, but more call him a Cony, and some call him the Crying Hare. This is because he uses his voice a great deal, which is something no member of the Hare family does. In size he is just about as big as one of your half-grown babies, Peter, so, you see, he really is a very little fellow. His coat is grayish-brown. His ears are of good size, but instead of being long, are round. He has small bright eyes. His legs are short, his hind legs being very little longer than his front ones. He has hair on the soles of his feet just like the members of the hare family.”

“What about his tail?” piped up Peter Rabbit. You know Peter is very much interested in tails.

Old Mother Nature smiled. “He is worse off than you, Peter,” said she, “for he hasn’t any at all. That is, he hasn’t any that can be seen. He lives way up among the rocks of the great mountains above where the trees grow and often is a very near neighbor to Whistler.”

“I suppose that means that he makes his home down in under rocks, the same as Whistler does,” spoke up Johnny Chuck.

“Right,” replied Old Mother Nature. “He is such a little fellow that he can get through very narrow places, and he has his home and barns way down in among the rocks.”

“Barns!” exclaimed Happy Jack Squirrel. “Barns! What do you mean by barns?”

Old Mother Nature laughed. “I just call them barns,” said she, “because they are the places where he stores away his hay, just as Farmer Brown stores away his hay in his barn. I suppose you would call them storehouses.”

At the mention of hay, Peter Rabbit sat bolt upright and his eyes were wide open with astonishment. “Did you say hay?” he exclaimed. “Where under the sun does he get hay way up there, and what does he want of it?”

There was a twinkle in Old Mother Nature’s eyes as she replied, “He makes that hay just as you see Farmer Brown make hay every summer. It is what he lives on in the winter and in bad weather. Little Chief knows just as much about the proper way of making hay as Farmer Brown does. Even way up among the rocks there are places where grass and peas-vines and other green things grow. Little Chief lives on these in summer. But he is as wise and thrifty as any Squirrel, another way in which he differs from the Hare family. He cuts them when they are ready for cutting and spreads them out on the rocks to dry in the sun. He knows that if he should take them down into his barns while they are fresh and green they would sour and spoil; so he never stores them away until they are thoroughly dry. Then, of course, they are hay, for hay is nothing but sun-dried grass cut before it has begun to die. When his hay is just as dry as it should be, he takes it down and stores it away in his barns, which are nothing but little caves down in among the rocks. There he has it for use in winter when there is no green food.

“Little Chief is so nearly the color of the rocks that it takes sharp eyes to see him when he is sitting still. He has a funny little squeaking voice, and he uses it a great deal. It is a funny voice because it is hard to tell just where it comes from. It seems to come from nowhere in particular. Sometimes he can be heard squeaking way down in his home under the rocks. Like Johnny Chuck, he prefers to sleep at night and be abroad during the day. Because he is so small he must always be on the lookout for enemies. At the first hint of danger he scampers to safety in among the rocks, and there he scolds whoever has frightened him. There is no more loveable little person in all my great family than this little haymaker of the mountains of the Great West.”

“That haymaking is a pretty good idea of Little Chief’s,” remarked Peter Rabbit, scratching a long ear with a long hind foot. “I’ve a great mind to try it myself.”

Everybody laughed right out, for everybody knew just how easy-going and thriftless Peter was. Peter himself grinned. He couldn’t help it.

“That would be a very good idea, Peter,” said Old Mother Nature. “By the way, there is another haymaker out in those same great mountains of the Far West.”

“Who?” demanded Peter and Johnny Chuck and Happy Jack Squirrel, all in the same breath.

“Stubtail the Mountain Beaver,” declared Peter promptly. “I suppose Stubtail is his cousin.”

Old Mother Nature shook her head. “No,” said she. “No. Stubtail and Paddy are no more closely related than the rest of you. Stubtail isn’t a Beaver at all. His proper name is Sewellel. Sometimes he is called Showt’l and sometimes the Boomer, and sometimes the Chehalis, but most folks call him the Mountain Beaver.”

“Is it because he looks like Paddy the Beaver?” Striped Chipmunk asked.

“No,” replied Old Mother Nature. “He looks more like Jerry Muskrat than he does like Paddy. He is about Jerry’s size and looks very much as Jerry would if he had no tail.”

“Hasn’t he any tail at all?” asked Peter.

“Yes, he has a little tail, a little stub of a tail, but it is so small that to look at him you would think he hadn’t any,” replied Old Mother Nature. “He is found out in the same mountains of the Far West where Whistler and Little Chief live, but instead of living way up high among the rocks he is at home down in the valleys where the ground is soft and the trees grow thickly. Stubtail has no use for rocks. He wants soft, wet ground where he can tunnel and tunnel to his heart’s content. In one thing Stubtail is very like Yap Yap the Prairie Dog.”

“What is that?” asked Johnny Chuck quickly, for, you know, Yap Yap is Johnny’s cousin.

“In his social habits,” replied Old Mother Nature. “Stubtail isn’t fond of living alone. He wants company of his own kind. So wherever you find Stubtail you are likely to find many of his family. They like to go visiting back and forth. They make little paths between their homes and all about through the thick ferns, and they keep these little paths free

and clear, so that they may run along them easily. Some of these little paths lead into long tunnels. These are made for safety. Usually the ground is so wet that there will be water running in the bottoms of these little tunnels."

"What kind of a house does Stubtail have?" inquired Johnny Chuck interestedly.

"A hole in the ground, of course," replied Old Mother Nature. "It is dug where the ground is drier than where the runways are made. Mrs. Stubtail makes a nest of dried ferns and close by they build two or three storehouses, for Stubtail and Mrs. Stubtail are thrifty people."

"I suppose he fills them with hay, for you said he is a haymaker," remarked Happy Jack Squirrel, who is always interested in storehouses.

"Yes," replied Old Mother Nature, "he puts hay in them. He cuts grasses, ferns, pea-vines and other green plants and carries them in little bundles to the entrance to his tunnel. There he piles them on sticks so as to keep them off he damp ground and so that the air can help dry them out. When they are dry, he takes them inside and stores them away. He also stores other things. He likes the roots of ferns. He cuts tender, young twigs from bushes and stores away some of these. He is fond of bark. In winter he is quite as active as in summer and tunnels about under the snow. Then he sometimes has Peter Rabbit's bad habit of killing trees by gnawing bark all around as high up as he can reach."

"Can he climb trees?" asked Chatterer the Red Squirrel.

"Just about as much as Johnny Chuck can," replied Old Mother Nature. "Sometimes he climbs up in low bushes or in small, low-branching trees to cut off tender shoots, but he doesn't do much of this sort of thing. His home is the ground. He is most active at night, but where undisturbed, is out more or less during the day. When he wants to cut off a twig he sits up like a Squirrel and holds the twig in his hands while he bites it off with his sharp teeth."

"You didn't tell us what color his coat is," said Peter Rabbit.

"I told you he looked very much like Jerry Muskrat," replied Old Mother Nature. "His coat is brown, much the color of Jerry's, but his fur is not nearly so soft and fine."

"I suppose he has enemies just as the rest of us little people have," said Peter.

"Of course," replied Old Mother Nature. "All little people have enemies, and most big ones too, for that matter. King Eagle is one and Yowler the Bob Cat is another. They are always watching for Stubtail. That is why he digs so many tunnels. He can travel under the ground then. My goodness, how time flies! Scamper home, all of you, for I have too much to do to talk any more to-day."

> **End of chapter 9.** Narrate. Chapter 10 follows as an optional second sitting.

OPTIONAL · FRIDAY

# The Burgess Animal Book · Chapter 10 · Prickly Porky and Grubby Gopher

*Thornton W. Burgess, The Burgess Animal Book for Children (Boston: Little, Brown, 1920), ch. X,* ***pp. 82–89****. Optional second sitting. Text: Project Gutenberg #2441. Public domain. · This packet: pp. 28–30*

All the way to school the next morning Peter Rabbit wondered who they would learn about that day. He was so busy wondering that he was heedless. Peter is apt to be heedless at times. The result was that as he hopped out of a bramble-tangle just within the edge of the Green Forest, he all but landed in something worse than the worst brambles that ever grew. It was only by a wild side jump that he saved himself. Peter had almost landed among the thousand little spears of Prickly Porky the Porcupine.

“Gracious!” exclaimed Peter.

“Why don’t you look where you are going,” grunted Prickly Porky. Plainly he was rather peevish. “It wouldn’t be my fault if you had a few of my little spears sticking in you this very minute, and it would serve you right.” He waddled along a few steps, then began talking again. “I don’t see why Old Mother Nature sent for me this morning,” he grumbled. “I hate a long walk.”

Peter pricked up his long ears. “I know!” he cried. “You’re going to school, Prickly Porky. You’re a Rodent, and we are going to learn all about you this morning.”

“I’m not a Rodent; I’m a Porcupine,” grunted Prickly Porky indignantly.

“You’re a Rodent just the same. You’ve got big gnawing teeth, and any one with that kind of teeth is a Rodent,” retorted Peter. Then at a sudden thought a funny look passed over his face. “Why, that means that you and I are related in a way,” he added.

“Don’t believe it,” grunted Prickly Porky, still shuffling along. “Don’t believe it. Don’t want to be related to anybody as heedless as you. What is this school, anyway? Don’t want to go to school. Know all I want to know. Know how to get all I want to eat and how to make everybody get out of my way and leave me alone, and that’s enough to know.” He rattled the thousand little spears hidden in his coat, and Peter shivered at the sound. It was a most unpleasant sound.

“Well, some folks do like to be stupid,” snapped Peter and hurried on, lipperty-lipperty-lip, while Prickly Porky slowly shuffled and rattled along behind.

All the others were there when Peter arrived. Prickly Porky wasn’t even in sight. Old Mother Nature wasted no time. She has too much to do ever to waste time. She called the school to order at once.

“Yesterday,” she began, “I told you about two little haymakers of the high mountains of the Far West. Who were they, Peter Rabbit?”

“Little Chief Hare, called the Pika or Cony, and Stubtail the Mountain Beaver or Sewellel,” replied Peter with great promptness.

“Right,” said Old Mother Nature. “Now I am going to tell you of one of my little plowmen who also lives in the Far West but prefers the great plains to the high mountains, though he is sometimes found in the latter. He is Grubby the Gopher, a member of the same order the rest of you belong to, but of a family quite his own. He is properly called the Pocket Gopher, and way down in the Southeast, where he is also found, he is called a Salamander, though what for I haven’t the least idea.”

“Does he have pockets in his cheeks like mine?” asked Striped Chipmunk eagerly.

“He has pockets in his cheeks, and that is why he is called Pocket Gopher,” replied Old Mother Nature; “but they are not at all like yours, Striped Chipmunk. Yours are on the inside of your cheeks, but his are on the outside.”

“How funny!” exclaimed Striped Chipmunk.

“Your pockets are small compared with those of Grubby,” continued Old Mother Nature. “One of his covers almost the whole side of his head back to his short neck, and it is lined with fur, and remember he has two of them. Grubby uses these for carrying food and never for carrying out earth when he is digging a tunnel, as some folks think he does. He stuffs them full with his front feet and empties them by pressing them from the back with his feet. The Gopher family is quite large and the members range in size from the size of Danny Meadow Mouse to that of Robber the Rat, only these bigger members are stouter and heavier than Robber. Some are reddish-brown and some are gray. But whatever his size and wherever he is found, Grubby’s habits are the same.”

All this time Peter Rabbit had been fidgeting about. It was quite clear that Peter had something on his mind. Now as Old Mother Nature paused, Peter found the chance he had been waiting for. “If you please, why did you call him a plowman?” he asked eagerly.

“I’m coming to that all in due time,” replied Old Mother Nature, smiling at Peter’s eagerness. “Grubby Gopher spends most of his life underground, very much like Miner the Mole, whom you all know. He can dig tunnels just about as fast. His legs are short, and his front legs and feet are very stout and strong. They are armed with very long, strong claws and it is with these and the help of his big cutting teeth that Grubby digs. He throws the earth under him and then kicks it behind him with his hind feet. When he has quite a pile behind him he turns around, and with his front feet and head pushes it along to a little side tunnel and then up to the surface of the ground. As soon as he has it all out he plugs up the opening and goes back to digging. The loose earth he has pushed out makes little mounds, and he makes one of these mounds every few feet.

“Grubby is a great worker. He is very industrious. Since he is underground, it doesn’t make much difference to him whether it be night or day. In summer, during the hottest part of the day, he rests. His eyes are small and weak because he has little use for them, coming out on the surface very seldom and then usually in the dusk. He has a funny little tail without any hair on it; this is very sensitive and serves him as a sort of guide when he runs backward along his tunnel, which he can do quite fast. A funny thing about those long claws on his front feet is that he folds them under when he is walking or running. Do any of you know why Farmer Brown plows his garden?”

As she asked this, Old Mother Nature looked from one to another, and each in turn shook his head. “It is to mix the dead vegetable matter thoroughly with the earth so that the roots of the plants may get it easily,” explained Old Mother Nature. “By making those tunnels in every direction and bringing up the earth below to the surface, Grubby Gopher does the same thing. That is why I call him my little plowman. He loosens up the hard, packed earth and mixes the vegetable matter with it and so makes it easy for seeds to sprout and plants to grow.”

“Then he must be one of the farmer’s best friends,” spoke up Happy Jack Squirrel.

Old Mother Nature shook her head. “He has been in the past,” said she. “He has done a wonderful work in helping make the land fit for farming. But where land is being farmed he is a dreadful pest, I am sorry to say. You see he eats the crops the farmer tries to raise, and the new mounds he is all the time throwing up bury a lot of the young plants, and in the meadows make it very hard to use a mowing machine for cutting hay. Then Grubby gets into young orchards and cuts off all the tender roots of young trees. This kills them. You see he is fond of tender roots, seeds, stems of grass and grain, and is never happier than when he can find a field of potatoes.

“Being such a worker, he has to have a great deal to eat. Then, too, he stores away a great deal for winter, for he doesn’t sleep in winter as Johnny Chuck does. He even tunnels about under the snow. Sometimes he fills these little snow tunnels with the earth he brings up from below, and when the snow melts it leaves queer little earth ridges to show where the tunnels were.

“Grubby is very neat in his habits and keeps his home and himself very clean. During the day he leaves one of his mounds open for a little while to let in fresh air. But it is only for a little while. Then he closes it again. He doesn’t dare leave it open very long, for fear Shadow the Weasel or a certain big Snake called the Gopher Snake will find it

and come in after him. Digger the Badger is the only one of his enemies who can dig fast enough to dig him out, but at night, when he likes to come out for a little air or to cut grain and grass, he must always watch for Hooty the Owl. Old Man Coyote and members of the Hawk family are always looking for him by day, so you see he has plenty of enemies, like the rest of you.

“He got the name Gopher because that comes from a word meaning honeycomb, and Grubby’s tunnels go in every direction until the ground is like honeycomb. He isn’t a bit social and has rather a mean disposition. He is always ready to fight. On the plains he has done a great deal to make the soil fine and rich, as I have already told you, but on hillsides he does a great deal of harm. The water runs down his tunnels and washes away the soil. Because of this and the damage he does to crops, man is his greatest enemy. But man has furnished him with new and splendid foods easy to get, and so Grubby’s family increases faster than it used to, in spite of traps and poison. Hello! See who’s here! It is about time.”

There was a shuffling and rattling and grunting, and Prickly Porky climbed up on an old stump, looking very peevish and much out of sorts. He had come to school much against his will.

> **End of chapter 10.** If you skip it, it opens Week 10.

READ THIS · FRIDAY · FROM YOUR SHELF

# Grimm’s Fairy Tales · one gentle tale

*Pantheon edition · owned copy · by title only · never reprinted*

## Open your Pantheon Grimm.

Suggested: *The Golden Goose*. Alternates: *Mother Holle* or *The Fisherman and His Wife* if it’s familiar.

Find it by title in the contents. Read once. Close the book. Narrate. Never reprint.

OPEN YOUR COPY · FRIDAY

# A Child’s History of the World · Knights and Days of Chivalry

*V. M. Hillyer — owned copy · ch. 51 in newer printings, ch. 49 in the 1924 first edition · never reprinted in this packet*

## Open your Hillyer to “Knights and Days of Chivalry.”

One sitting, ~15 min. Read once, close the book, narrate, stop.

Follows Week 7’s “Real Castles.” Optional: design a family coat of arms afterward.

Never reprint Hillyer from your copy.

# Saturday

**HAVE READY**

Bible · Ray's (Lesson 28) · Harvey's · *Understood Betsy* ch. 8 (printed, two sittings) · *Pilgrim's Progress* (printed) · *Trial and Triumph* (your copy, Anselm) · nature notebook · McGuffey nearby

**8:00** **Nature walk** TRACY JOINS

Twenty minutes. Check the feeder. One bird, one berry. Draw one thing later.

**8:25** **Bible · Luke 21:20–38**

Jerusalem, the signs in the sky, the fig tree, and "stay awake." Read once, narrate the main thread, stop.

**8:40** **Hymn or folk song** TRACY JOINS

Whichever she asks for.

**8:50** **Ray's · Lesson 28**

One lesson. Oral first. That finishes this week's four.

**9:10** **Harvey's · short sitting**

Second sitting of the week. Ten minutes.

**9:25** **Understood Betsy ch. 8 (first part)**

Printed. Read to the marked break (~20 min). Narrate. The rest this afternoon or next week.

**9:55** **Pilgrim's Progress**

Good-will and the Interpreter's house. Printed, about 1,300 words. Narrate. May split at "he again bid him God-speed."

**10:15** **Trial and Triumph · Anselm**

From your copy. One sitting, ~15–20 min. Narrate. Dictation is optional today; skip it if the morning is full.

# How to teach Saturday

> **Luke, Betsy, Pilgrim's Progress, and Anselm.** Harvey's second sitting. If the day is busy, keep Bible, Ray's, and Betsy, and move Anselm to next Wednesday.

## Bible

Luke 21:20–38. Open your ESV. Jesus tells what will happen to Jerusalem, speaks of signs in the sun, moon, and stars, gives the little parable of the fig tree, and tells his followers to stay awake and pray. Then he teaches in the temple each day. One reading. Narrate the main thread.

## Understood Betsy

At supper Betsy hears about 'Lias Brewster, a ragged little boy with no one to care for him. She can't stop thinking about him. At school she and the other girls form a sewing society to make him clothes, and Cousin Ann teaches them. Two sittings; ask what the girls decided to make.

## Pilgrim's Progress

Good-will hears Christian's story, says no one who comes is turned away, and points out the straight, narrow way. Christian asks about his burden; he must carry it until he reaches the place of deliverance. At the Interpreter's house he sees the first picture, a grave man pleading with people, with a crown over his head. Next week: more rooms in the Interpreter's house.

## Trial and Triumph

Anselm, from your own copy. A gentle scholar who became Archbishop and stood firm when the king wanted his way. One sitting. Never reprint.

## Dictation (optional)

Prepared dictation from *"Cherries, ripe cherries!" The old woman cried,* Five minutes, only if she is fresh.

Tracy: nature, Bible as long as she'll sit, song, maybe Betsy listening. McGuffey during Ray's, Harvey's, and Anselm. Week 10 brings Exodus 31:18–33, Luke 22:1–13, Island Story ch. 30, and Little Duke ch. 5 second half.

READ THIS · SATURDAY

# Bible · Luke 21:20–38

*ESV · open your physical copy · never reprint verse text*

### Open your ESV to Luke 21:20–38.

Read once. Close the Bible. Narrate. Then stop.

Do not print or paste ESV (or any modern) Bible text — use the physical book only.
Jerusalem, signs in the sky, the fig tree, stay awake. Read once, narrate the main thread.

# Understood Betsy · Chapter 8 · Betsy Starts a Sewing Society

*Dorothy Canfield Fisher, Understood Betsy (New York: Henry Holt, 1917), ch. VIII,* ***pp. 161–185****. Text: Project Gutenberg #5347. Public domain. Full chapter, in two sittings. · This packet: pp. 36–41*

Betsy and Molly had taken Deborah to school with them. Deborah was the old wooden doll with brown, painted curls. She had lain in a trunk almost ever since Aunt Abigail's childhood, because Cousin Ann had never cared for dolls when she was a little girl. At first Betsy had not dared to ask to see her, much less to play with her, but when Ellen, as she had promised, came over to Putney Farm that first Saturday she had said right out, as soon as she landed in the house, "Oh, Mrs. Putney, can't we play with Deborah?" And Aunt Abigail had answered: "Why YES, of course! I KNEW there was something I've kept forgetting!" She went up with them herself to the cold attic and opened the little hair-trunk under the eaves.

There lay a doll, flat on her back, looking up at them brightly out of her blue eyes.

"Well, Debby dear," said Aunt Abigail, taking her up gently. "It's a good long time since you and I played under the lilac bushes, isn't it? I expect you've been pretty lonesome up here all these years. Never you mind, you'll have some good times again, now." She pulled down the doll's full, ruffled skirt, straightened the lace at the neck of her dress, and held her for a moment, looking down at her silently. You could tell by the way she spoke, by the way she touched Deborah, by the way she looked at her, that she had loved the doll very dearly, and maybe still did, a little.

When she put Deborah into Betsy's arms, the child felt that she was receiving something very precious, almost something alive. She and Ellen looked with delight at the yards and yards of picot-edged ribbon, sewed on by hand to the ruffles of the skirt, and lifted up the silk folds to admire the carefully made, full petticoats and frilly drawers, the pretty, soft old kid shoes and white stockings. Aunt Abigail looked at them with an absent smile on her lips, as though she were living over old scenes.

[Illustration: Betsy and Ellen and the old doll.]

Finally, "It's too cold to play up here," she said, coming to herself with a long breath. "You'd better bring Deborah and the trunk down into the south room." She carried the doll, and Betsy and Ellen each took an end of the old trunk, no larger than a modern suitcase. They settled themselves on the big couch, back of the table with the lamp. Old Shep was on it, but Betsy coaxed him off by putting down some bones Cousin Ann had been saving for him. When he finished those and came back for the rest of his snooze, he found his place occupied by the little girls, sitting cross-legged, examining the contents of the trunk, all spread out around them. Shep sighed deeply and sat down with his nose resting on the couch near Betsy's knee, following all their movements with his kind, dark eyes. Once in a while Betsy stopped hugging Deborah or exclaiming over a new dress long enough to pat Shep's head and fondle his ears. This was what he was waiting for, and every time she did it he wagged his tail thumpingly against the floor.

After that Deborah and her trunk were kept downstairs where Betsy could play with her. And often she was taken to school. You never heard of such a thing as taking a doll to school, did you? Well, I told you this was a queer, old-fashioned school that any modern School Superintendent would sniff at. As a matter of fact, it was not only Betsy who took her doll to school; all the little girls did, whenever they felt like it. Miss Benton, the teacher, had a shelf for them in the entry-way where the wraps were hung, and the dolls sat on it and waited patiently all through lessons. At recess time or nooning each little mother snatched her own child and began to play. As soon as it grew warm enough to play outdoors without just racing around every minute to keep from freezing to death, the dolls and their mothers went out to a great pile of rocks at one end of the bare, stony field which was the playground.

There they sat and played in the spring sunshine, warmer from day to day. There were a great many holes and shelves and pockets and little caves in the rocks which made lovely places for playing keep-house. Each little girl had her own particular cubby-holes and "rooms," and they "visited" their dolls back and forth all around the pile. And as they

played they talked very fast about all sorts of things, being little girls and not boys who just yelled and howled inarticulately as they played ball or duck-on-a-rock or prisoner's goal, racing and running and wrestling noisily all around the rocks.

There was one child who neither played with the girls nor ran and whooped with the boys. This was little six-year-old 'Lias, one of the two boys in Molly's first grade. At recess time he generally hung about the school door by himself, looking moodily down and knocking the toe of his ragged, muddy shoe against a stone. The little girls were talking about him one day as they played. "My! Isn't that 'Lias Brewster the horridest-looking child!" said Eliza, who had the second grade all to herself, although Molly now read out of the second reader with her.

"Mercy, yes! So ragged!" said Anastasia Monahan, called Stashie for short. She was a big girl, fourteen years old, who was in the seventh grade.

"He doesn't look as if he EVER combed his hair!" said Betsy. "It looks just like a wisp of old hay."

"And sometimes," little Molly proudly added her bit to the talk of the older girls, "he forgets to put on any stockings and just has his dreadful old shoes on over his dirty, bare feet."

"I guess he hasn't GOT any stockings half the time," said big Stashie scornfully. "I guess his stepfather drinks 'em up."

"How CAN he drink up stockings!" asked Molly, opening her round eyes very wide.

"Sh! You mustn't ask. Little girls shouldn't know about such things, should they, Betsy?"

"No INDEED," said Betsy, looking mysterious. As a matter of fact, she herself had no idea what Stashie meant, but she looked wise and said nothing.

Some of the boys had squatted down near the rocks for a game of marbles now.

"Well, anyhow," said Molly resentfully, "I don't care what his stepfather does to his stockings. I wish 'Lias would wear 'em to school. And lots of times he hasn't anything on under those horrid old overalls either! I can see his bare skin through the torn places."

"I wish he didn't have to sit so near me," said Betsy complainingly. "He's SO dirty."

"Well, I don't want him near ME, either!" cried all the other little girls at once. Ralph glanced up at them frowning, from where he knelt with his middle finger crooked behind a marble ready for a shot. He looked as he always did, very rough and half-threatening. "Oh, you girls make me sick!" he said. He sent his marble straight to the mark, pocketed his opponent's, and stood up, scowling at the little mothers. "I guess if you had to live the way he does you'd be dirty! Half the time he don't get anything to eat before he comes to school, and if my mother didn't put up some extra for him in my box he wouldn't get any lunch either. And then you go and jump on him!"

"Why doesn't his own mother put up his lunch?" Betsy challenged their critic.

"He hasn't got any mother. She's dead," said Ralph, turning away with his hands in his pockets. He yelled to the boys, "Come on, fellers, beat-che to the bridge and back!" and was off, with the others racing at his heels.

"Well, anyhow, I don't care; he IS dirty and horrid!" said Stashie emphatically, looking over at the drooping, battered little figure, leaning against the school door, listlessly kicking at a stone.

But Betsy did not say anything more just then.

The teacher, who "boarded 'round," was staying at Putney Farm at that time, and that evening, as they all sat around the lamp in the south room, Betsy looked up from her game of checkers with Uncle Henry and asked, "How can anybody drink up stockings?"

"Mercy, child! what are you talking about?" asked Aunt Abigail.

Betsy repeated what Anastasia Monahan had said, and was flattered by the instant, rather startled attention given her by the grown-ups. “Why, I didn’t know that Bud Walker had taken to drinking again!” said Uncle Henry. “My! That’s too bad!”

“Who takes care of that child anyhow, now that poor Susie is dead?” Aunt Abigail asked of everybody in general.

“Is he just living there ALONE, with that good-for-nothing stepfather? How do they get enough to EAT?” said Cousin Ann, looking troubled.

Apparently Betsy’s question had brought something half forgotten and altogether neglected into their minds. They talked for some time after that about ’Lias, the teacher confirming what Betsy and Stashie had said.

“And we sitting right here with plenty to eat and never raising a hand!” cried Aunt Abigail.

“How you WILL let things slip out of your mind!” said Cousin Ann remorsefully.

It struck Betsy vividly that ’Lias was not at all the one they blamed for his objectionable appearance. She felt quite ashamed to go on with the other things she and the little girls had said, and fell silent, pretending to be very much absorbed in her game of checkers.

“Do you know,” said Aunt Abigail suddenly, as though an inspiration had just struck her, “I wouldn’t be a bit surprised if that Elmore Pond might adopt ’Lias if he was gone at the right way.”

“Who’s Elmore Pond?” asked the schoolteacher.

“Why, you must have seen him—that great, big, red-faced, good-natured-looking man that comes through here twice a year, buying stock. He lives over Bigby way, but his wife was a Hillsboro girl, Matey Pelham—an awfully nice girl she was, too. They never had any children, and Matey told me the last time she was back for a visit that she and her husband talked quite often about adopting a little boy. Seems that Mr. Pond has always wanted a little boy. He’s such a nice man! ’Twould be a lovely home for a child.”

“But goodness!” said the teacher. “Nobody would want to adopt such an awful-looking little ragamuffin as that ’Lias. He looks so meeching, too. I guess his stepfather is real mean to him, when he’s been drinking, and it’s got ’Lias so he hardly dares hold his head up.”

The clock struck loudly. “Well, hear that!” said Cousin Ann. “Nine o’clock and the children not in bed! Molly’s most asleep this minute. Trot along with you, Betsy! Trot along, Molly. And, Betsy, be sure Molly’s nightgown is buttoned up all the way.”

So it happened that, although the grown-ups were evidently going on to talk about ’Lias Brewster, Betsy heard no more of what they said.

She herself went on thinking about ’Lias while she was undressing and answering absently little Molly’s chatter. She was thinking about him even after they had gone to bed, had put the light out, and were lying snuggled up to each other, back to front, their four legs, crooked at the same angle, fitting in together neatly like two spoons in a drawer. She was thinking about him when she woke up, and as soon as she could get hold of Cousin Ann she poured out a new plan. She had never been afraid of Cousin Ann since the evening Molly had fallen into the Wolf Pit and Betsy had seen that pleased smile on Cousin Ann’s firm lips. “Cousin Ann, couldn’t we girls at school get together and sew—you’d have to help us some—and make some nice, new clothes for little ’Lias Brewster, and fix him up so he’ll look better, and maybe that Mr. Pond will like him and adopt him?”

Cousin Ann listened attentively and nodded her head. “Yes, I think that would be a good idea,” she said. “We were thinking last night we ought to do something for him. If you’ll make the clothes, Mother’ll knit him some stockings and Father will get him some shoes. Mr. Pond never makes his spring trip till late May, so we’ll have plenty of time.”

> **Break here** for the first sitting. The rest can be read Saturday afternoon or next week.

SECOND SITTING

Betsy was full of importance that day at school and at recess time got the girls together on the rocks and told them all about the plan. “Cousin Ann says she’ll help us, and we can meet at our house every Saturday afternoon till we get them done. It’ll be fun! Aunt Abigail telephoned down to the store right away, and Mr. Wilkins says he’ll give the cloth if we’ll make it up.”

Betsy spoke very grandly of “making it up,” although she had hardly held a needle in her life, and when the Saturday afternoon meetings began she was ashamed to see how much better Ellen and even Eliza could sew than she. To keep her end up, she was driven to practising her stitches around the lamp in the evenings, with Aunt Abigail keeping an eye on her.

Cousin Ann supervised the sewing on Saturday afternoons and taught those of the little girls whose legs were long enough how to use the sewing machine. First they made a little pair of trousers out of an old gray woolen skirt of Aunt Abigail’s. This was for practice, before they cut into the piece of new blue serge that the storekeeper had sent up. Cousin Ann showed them how to pin the pattern on the goods and they each cut out one piece. Those flat, queer-shaped pieces of cloth certainly did look less like a pair of trousers to Betsy than anything she had ever seen. Then one of the girls read aloud very slowly the mysterious-sounding directions from the wrapper of the pattern about how to put the pieces together, Cousin Ann helped here a little, particularly just as they were about to put the sections together wrong-side-up. Stashie, as the oldest, did the first basting, putting the notches together carefully, just as they read the instructions aloud, and there, all of a sudden, was a rough little sketch of a pair of knee trousers, without any hem or any waist-band, of course, but just the two-legged, complicated shape they ought to be! It was like a miracle to Betsy! Then Cousin Ann helped them sew the seams on the machine, and they all turned to for the basting of the facings and the finishing. They each made one buttonhole. It was the first one Betsy had ever made, and when she got through she was as tired as though she had run all the way to school and back. Tired, but very proud; although when Cousin Ann inspected that buttonhole, she covered her face with her handkerchief for a minute, as though she were going to sneeze, although she didn’t sneeze at all.

It took them two Saturdays to finish up that trial pair of trousers, and when they showed the result to Aunt Abigail she was delighted. “Well, to think of that being my old skirt!” she said, putting on her spectacles to examine the work. She did not laugh, either, when she saw those buttonholes, but she got up hastily and went into the next room, where they soon heard her coughing.

Then they made a little blouse out of some new blue gingham. Cousin Ann happened to have enough left over from a dress she was making. This thin material was ever so much easier to manage than the gray flannel, and they had the little garment done in no time, even to the buttons and buttonholes. When it came to making the buttonholes, Cousin Ann sat right down with each one and supervised every stitch. You may not be surprised to know that they were a great improvement over the first batch.

Then, making a great ceremony of it, they began on the store material, working twice a week now, because May was slipping along very fast, and Mr. Pond might be there at any time. They knew pretty well how to go ahead on this one, after the experience of their first pair, and Cousin Ann was not much needed, except as adviser in hard places. She sat there in the room with them, doing some sewing of her own, so quiet that half the time they forgot she was there. It was great fun, sewing all together and chattering as they sewed.

A good deal of the time they talked about how splendid it was of them to be so kind to little ’Lias. “My! I don’t believe most girls would put themselves out this way for a dirty little boy!” said Stashie, complacently.

“No INDEED!” chimed in Betsy. “It’s just like a story, isn’t it—working and sacrificing for the poor!”

“I guess he’ll thank us all right for sure!” said Ellen. “He’ll never forget us as long as he lives, I don’t suppose.”

Betsy, her imagination fired by this suggestion, said, “I guess when he’s grown-up he’ll be telling everybody about how, when he was so poor and ragged, Stashie Monahan and Ellen Peters and Elizabeth Ann ...”

“And Eliza!” put in that little girl hastily, very much afraid she would not be given her due share of the glory.

Cousin Ann sewed, and listened, and said nothing.

Toward the end of May two little blouses, two pairs of trousers, two pairs of stockings, two sets of underwear (contributed by the teacher), and the pair of shoes Uncle Henry gave were ready. The little girls handled the pile of new garments with inexpressible pride, and debated just which way of bestowing them was sufficiently grand to be worthy the occasion. Betsy was for taking them to school and giving them to ’Lias one by one, so that each child could have her thanks separately. But Stashie wanted to take them to the house when ’Lias’s stepfather would be there, and shame him by showing that little girls had had to do what he ought to have done.

Cousin Ann broke into the discussion by asking, in her quiet, firm voice, “Why do you want ’Lias to know where the clothes come from?”

They had forgotten again that she was there, and turned around quickly to stare at her. Nobody could think of any answer to her very queer question. It had not occurred to any one that there could BE such a question.

Cousin Ann shifted her ground and asked another: “Why did you make these clothes, anyhow?”

They stared again, speechless. Why did she ask that? She knew why.

Finally little Molly said, in her honest, baby way, “Why, YOU know why, Miss Ann! So ’Lias Brewster will look nice, and Mr. Pond will maybe adopt him.”

“Well,” said Cousin Ann, “what has that got to do with ’Lias knowing who did it?”

“Why, he wouldn’t know who to be grateful to,” cried Betsy.

“Oh,” said Cousin Ann. “Oh, I see. You didn’t do it to help ’Lias. You did it to have him grateful to you. I see. Molly is such a little girl, it’s no wonder she didn’t really take in what you girls were up to.” She nodded her head wisely, as though now she understood.

But if she did, little Molly certainly did not. She had not the least idea what everybody was talking about. She looked from one sober, downcast face to another rather anxiously. What was the matter?

Apparently nothing was really the matter, she decided, for after a minute’s silence Miss Ann got up with entirely her usual face of cheerful gravity, and said: “Don’t you think you little girls ought to top off this last afternoon with a tea-party? There’s a new batch of cookies, and you can make yourselves some lemonade if you want to.”

They had these refreshments out on the porch, in the sunshine, with their dolls for guests and a great deal of chatter for sauce. Nobody said another word about how to give the clothes to ’Lias, till, just as the girls were going away, Betsy said, walking along with the two older ones, “Say, don’t you think it’d be fun to go some evening after dark and leave the clothes on ’Lias’s doorstep, and knock and run away quick before anybody comes to the door?” She spoke in an uncertain voice and smoothed Deborah’s carved wooden curls.

“Yes, I do!” said Ellen, not looking at Betsy but down at the weeds by the road. “I think it would be lots of fun!”

Little Molly, playing with Annie and Eliza, did not hear this; but she was allowed to go with the older girls on the great expedition.

It was a warm, dark evening in late May, with the frogs piping their sweet, high note, and the first of the fireflies wheeling over the wet meadows near the tumble-down house where ’Lias lived. The girls took turns in carrying the big paper-wrapped bundle, and stole along in the shadow of the trees, full of excitement, looking over their shoulders at nothing and pressing their hands over their mouths to keep back the giggles. There was, of course, no reason on earth why they should giggle, which is, of course, the very reason why they did. If you’ve ever been a little girl you know about that.

One window of the small house was dimly lighted, they found, when they came in sight of it, and they thrilled with excitement and joyful alarm. Suppose ’Lias’s dreadful stepfather should come out and yell at them! They came forward on tiptoe, making a great deal of noise by stepping on twigs, rustling bushes, crackling gravel under their feet and doing all the other things that make such a noise at night and never do in the daytime. But nobody stirred inside the room with the lighted window. They crept forward and peeped cautiously inside ... and stopped giggling. The dim

light coming from a little kerosene lamp with a smoky chimney fell on a dismal, cluttered room, a bare, greasy wooden table, and two broken-backed chairs, with little ’Lias in one of them. He had fallen asleep with his head on his arms, his pinched, dirty, sad little figure showing in the light from the lamp. His feet dangled high above the floor in their broken, muddy shoes. One sleeve was torn to the shoulder. A piece of dry bread had slipped from his bony little hand and a tin dipper stood beside him on the bare table. Nobody else was in the room, nor evidently in the darkened, empty, fireless house.

[Illustration: He had fallen asleep with his head on his arms.]

As long as she lives Betsy will never forget what she saw that night through that window. Her eyes grew very hot and her hands very cold. Her heart thumped hard. She reached for little Molly and gave her a great hug in the darkness. Suppose it were little Molly asleep there, all alone in the dirty, dismal house, with no supper and nobody to put her to bed. She found that Ellen, next her, was crying quietly into the corner of her apron.

Nobody said a word. Stashie, who had the bundle, walked around soberly to the front door, put it down, and knocked loudly. They all darted away noiselessly to the road, to the shadow of the trees, and waited until the door opened. A square of yellow light appeared, with ’Lias’s figure, very small, at the bottom of it. They saw him stoop and pick up the bundle and go back into the house. Then they went quickly and silently back, separating at the cross-roads with no good-night greetings.

Molly and Betsy began to climb the hill to Putney Farm. It was a very warm night for May, and little Molly began to puff for breath. “Let’s sit down on this rock awhile and rest,” she said.

They were half-way up the hill now. From the rock they could see the lights in the farmhouses scattered along the valley road and on the side of the mountain opposite them, like big stars fallen from the multitude above. Betsy lay down on the rock and looked up at the stars. After a silence little Molly’s chirping voice said, “Oh, I thought you said we were going to march up to ’Lias in school and give him his clothes. Did you forget about that?”

Betsy gave a wriggle of shame as she remembered that plan. “No, we didn’t forget it,” she said. “We thought this would be a better way.”

“But how’ll ’Lias know who to thank?” asked Molly.

“That’s no matter,” said Betsy. Yes, it was Elizabeth-Ann-that-was who said that. And meant it, too. She was not even thinking of what she was saying. Between her and the stars, thick over her in the black, soft sky, she saw again that dirty, disordered room and the little boy, all alone, asleep with a piece of dry bread in his bony little fingers.

She looked hard and long at that picture, all the time seeing the quiet stars through it. And then she turned over and hid her face on the rock. She had said her “Now I lay me” every night since she could remember, but she had never prayed till she lay there with her face on the rock, saying over and over, “Oh, God, please, please, PLEASE make Mr. Pond adopt ’Lias.”

**End of chapter 8.** Next week: chapter 9, The New Clothes Fail.

# The Pilgrim’s Progress · Good-will, then the Interpreter’s house

*John Bunyan, The Pilgrim’s Progress (London: J. M. Dent; New York: E. P. Dutton, 1910 edition, illustrated by Frank C. Papé),* ***pp. 28–31****. Text: Project Gutenberg #131 (bracketed Scripture references and section numbers removed). Public domain. About 1,300 words; may be split. · This packet: pp. 42–44*

So when he was got in, the man of the gate asked him who directed him thither?

CHR. Evangelist bid me come hither, and knock, (as I did); and he said that you, Sir, would tell me what I must do.

GOOD-WILL. An open door is set before thee, and no man can shut it.

CHR. Now I begin to reap the benefits of my hazards.

GOOD-WILL. But how is it that you came alone?

CHR. Because none of my neighbours saw their danger, as I saw mine.

GOOD-WILL. Did any of them know of your coming?

CHR. Yes; my wife and children saw me at the first, and called after me to turn again; also, some of my neighbours stood crying and calling after me to return; but I put my fingers in my ears, and so came on my way.

GOOD-WILL. But did none of them follow you, to persuade you to go back?

CHR. Yes, both Obstinate and Pliable; but when they saw that they could not prevail, Obstinate went railing back, but Pliable came with me a little way.

GOOD-WILL. But why did he not come through?

CHR. We, indeed, came both together, until we came at the Slough of Despond, into the which we also suddenly fell. And then was my neighbour, Pliable, discouraged, and would not venture further. Wherefore, getting out again on that side next to his own house, he told me I should possess the brave country alone for him; so he went his way, and I came mine—he after Obstinate, and I to this gate.

GOOD-WILL. Then said Good-will, Alas, poor man! is the celestial glory of so small esteem with him, that he counteth it not worth running the hazards of a few difficulties to obtain it?

CHR. Truly, said Christian, I have said the truth of Pliable, and if I should also say all the truth of myself, it will appear there is no betterment betwixt him and myself. It is true, he went back to his own house, but I also turned aside to go in the way of death, being persuaded thereto by the carnal arguments of one Mr. Worldly Wiseman.

GOOD-WILL. Oh, did he light upon you? What! he would have had you a sought for ease at the hands of Mr. Legality. They are, both of them, a very cheat. But did you take his counsel?

CHR. Yes, as far as I durst; I went to find out Mr. Legality, until I thought that the mountain that stands by his house would have fallen upon my head; wherefore there I was forced to stop.

GOOD-WILL. That mountain has been the death of many, and will be the death of many more; it is well you escaped being by it dashed in pieces.

CHR. Why, truly, I do not know what had become of me there, had not Evangelist happily met me again, as I was musing in the midst of my dumps; but it was God’s mercy that he came to me again, for else I had never come hither. But now I am come, such a one as I am, more fit, indeed, for death, by that mountain, than thus to stand talking with my lord; but, oh, what a favour is this to me, that yet I am admitted entrance here!

GOOD-WILL. We make no objections against any, notwithstanding all that they have done before they came hither. They are in no wise cast out; and therefore, good Christian, come a little way with me, and I will teach thee about the way thou must go. Look before thee; dost thou see this narrow way? THAT is the way thou must go; it was cast up by the patriarchs, prophets, Christ, and his apostles; and it is as straight as a rule can make it. This is the way thou must go.

CHR. But, said Christian, are there no turnings or windings by which a stranger may lose his way?

GOOD-WILL. Yes, there are many ways butt down upon this, and they are crooked and wide. But thus thou mayest distinguish the right from the wrong, the right only being straight and narrow.

Then I saw in my dream that Christian asked him further if he could not help him off with his burden that was upon his back; for as yet he had not got rid thereof, nor could he by any means get it off without help.

He told him, As to thy burden, be content to bear it, until thou comest to the place of deliverance; for there it will fall from thy back of itself.

Then Christian began to gird up his loins, and to address himself to his journey. So the other told him, That by that he was gone some distance from the gate, he would come at the house of the Interpreter, at whose door he should knock, and he would show him excellent things. Then Christian took his leave of his friend, and he again bid him God-speed.

> **Optional break.** If she is tired, stop here and read the Interpreter's house another day.

SECOND SITTING

Then he went on till he came to the house of the Interpreter, where he knocked over and over; at last one came to the door, and asked who was there.

CHR. Sir, here is a traveller, who was bid by an acquaintance of the good-man of this house to call here for my profit; I would therefore speak with the master of the house. So he called for the master of the house, who, after a little time, came to Christian, and asked him what he would have.

CHR. Sir, said Christian, I am a man that am come from the City of Destruction, and am going to the Mount Zion; and I was told by the man that stands at the gate, at the head of this way, that if I called here, you would show me excellent things, such as would be a help to me in my journey.

INTER. Then said the Interpreter, Come in; I will show that which will be profitable to thee. So he commanded his man to light the candle, and bid Christian follow him: so he had him into a private room, and bid his man open a door; the which when he had done, Christian saw the picture of a very grave person hang up against the wall; and this was the fashion of it. It had eyes lifted up to heaven, the best of books in his hand, the law of truth was written upon his lips, the world was behind his back. It stood as if it pleaded with men, and a crown of gold did hang over his head.

CHR. Then said Christian, What meaneth this?

INTER. The man whose picture this is, is one of a thousand; he can beget children, travail in birth with children, and nurse them himself when they are born. And whereas thou seest him with his eyes lift up to heaven, the best of books in his hand, and the law of truth writ on his lips, it is to show thee that his work is to know and unfold dark things to sinners; even as also thou seest him stand as if he pleaded with men: and whereas thou seest the world as cast behind him, and that a crown hangs over his head, that is to show thee that slighting and despising the things that are present, for the love that he hath to his Master's service, he is sure in the world that comes next to have glory for his reward. Now, said the Interpreter, I have showed thee this picture first, because the man whose picture this is, is the only man whom the Lord of the place whither thou art going, hath authorised to be thy guide in all difficult places thou mayest meet with in the way; wherefore, take good heed to what I have shewed thee, and bear well in thy mind what thou hast seen, lest in thy journey thou meet with some that pretend to lead thee right, but their way goes down to death.

> **Stop here.** Next week: more rooms in the Interpreter’s house.

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